

Gamification

How experiences draw us in

Club Meeting - 9/22

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This will be shown again at the end of the meeting too!

While you wait, enjoy this chrome dino :)





Gamification

gam·i·fi·ca·tion ,gā-mə-fə-'kā-shən

: the process of adding games or gamelike elements to something (such as a task) so as to encourage participation

Source: <https://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/gamification>



In other words...

Making someone interested in doing something by
making it *feel* like a **game**.

Why do this?

- Some tasks are just inherently boring
 - Think filing taxes, memorizing vocab, brushing your teeth
 - We know we *need* to do them to be responsible adults, but they aren't enticing on their own
- Gamifying tasks artificially increases the user's sense of **reward**
 - The task remains as hard as it was, but the user feels they can *justify* its worth
 - Reframes the task into a fun **challenge**, rather than just feeling like homework
 - **Example:** Using a *streak* to get a user to study a bit of Spanish every day



What makes a task gamifiable?



- Gamifying tasks tends to be most effective when the given task fits within these categories:
 - **Consistent Repetition:**
 - Tasks that repeat can feel dull if they result in the same outcome every time
 - Gamifying these tasks by adding **XP**, **levels**, or **streaks** can make each repetition feel like *progress*
 - **Clear Goals:**
 - In order for a user to be rewarded, a task needs to be *quantifiable*
 - There needs to be a clear completion point, so the system can provide instant feedback (success or failure)

What makes a task gamifiable?



- Gamifying tasks tends to be most effective when the given task fits within these categories:
 - **Opportunity for Mastery:**
 - If a user can see an end in sight, they are far more likely to stay motivated
 - They can see their own growth, whether through progress bars or by counting the number of steps completed
 - **Variable Levels of Difficulty:**
 - Scaling difficulty can keep a user in a *flow state*, where they don't feel the task is too easy or too hard
 - This will keep them **engaged** without feeling **frustrated**

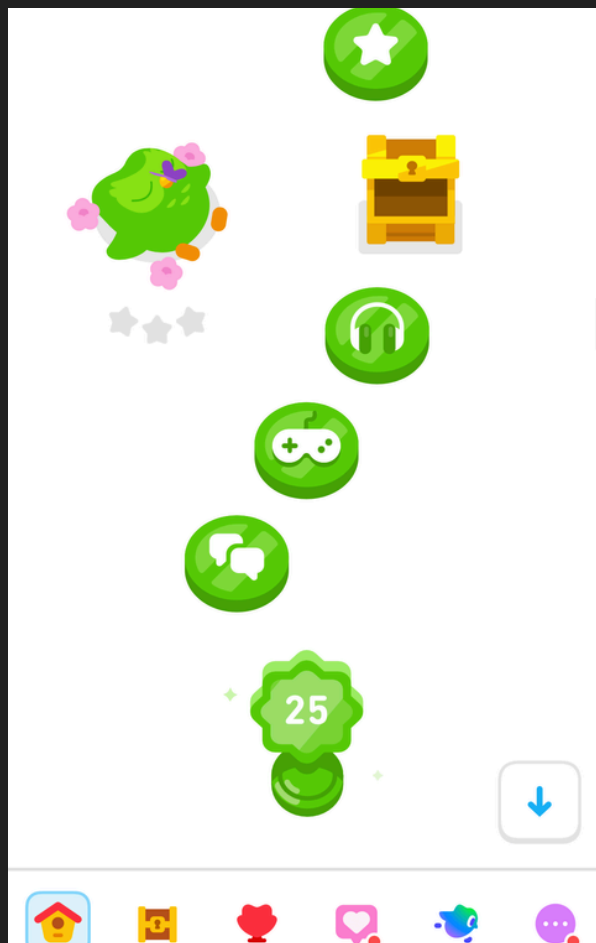
The Gold Standard



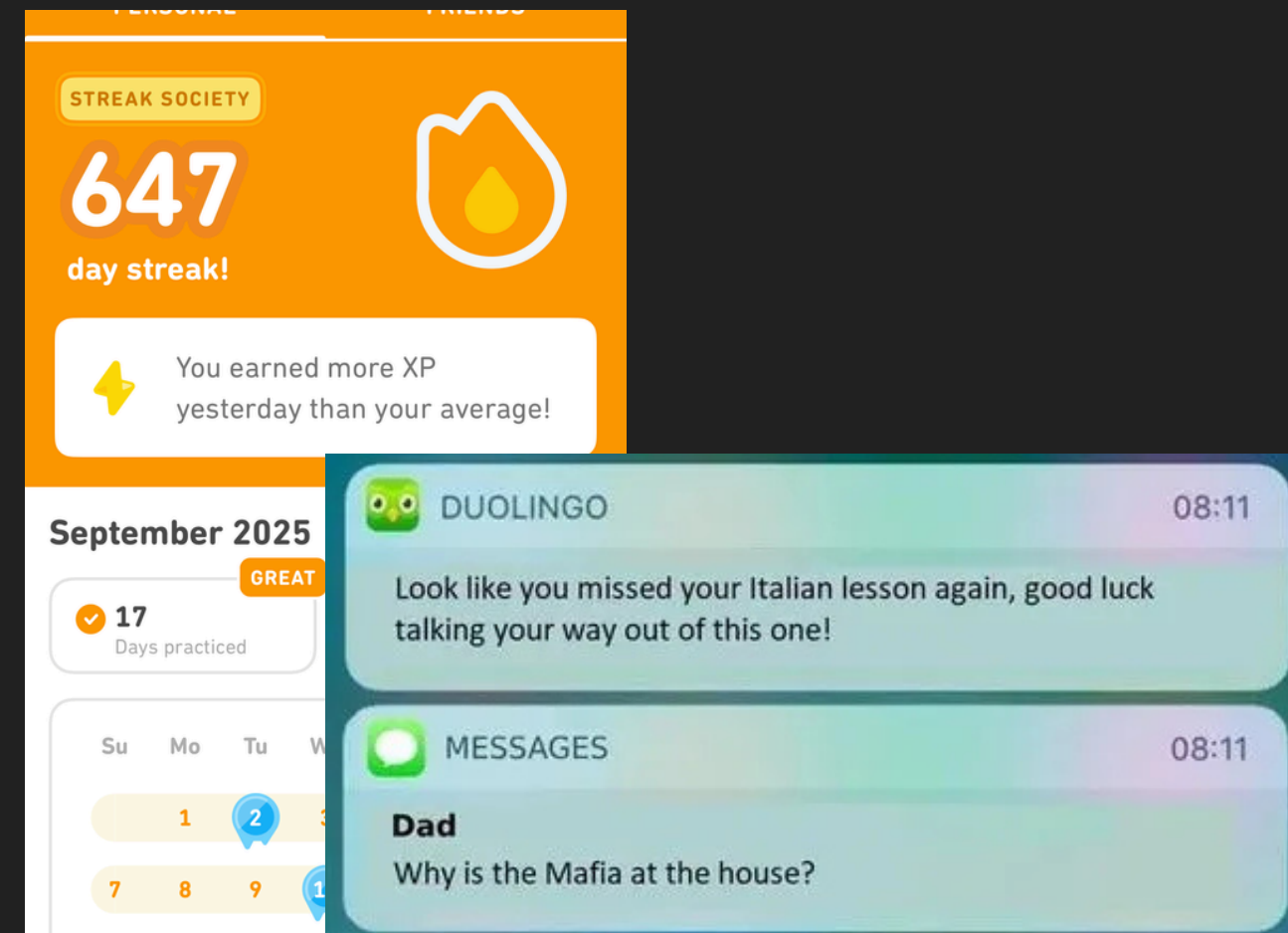
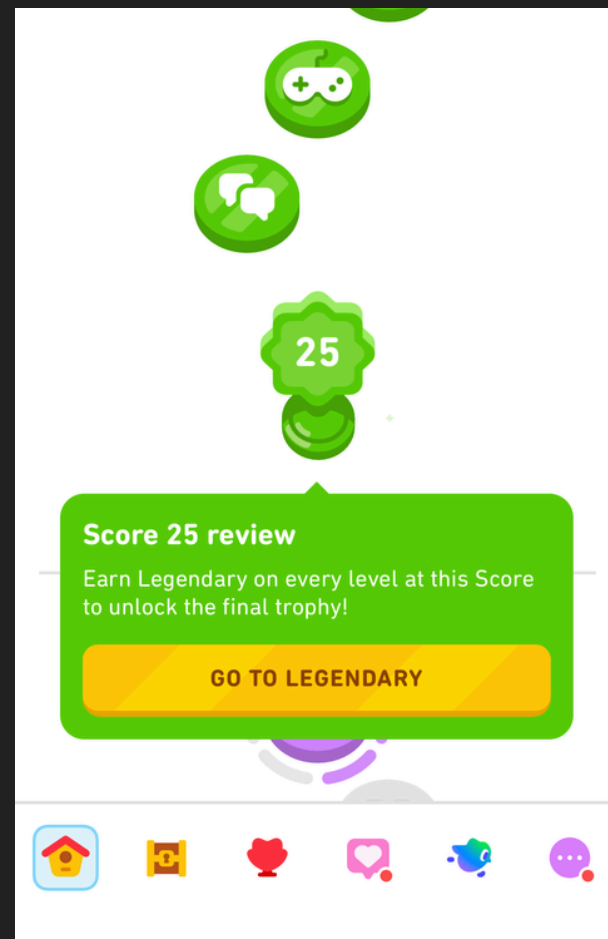
Duolingo!
(A Pittsburgh Icon)

Duolingo has it all

It's really the only example you need. It's *seriously* impressive how many game mechanics they crammed into this app.



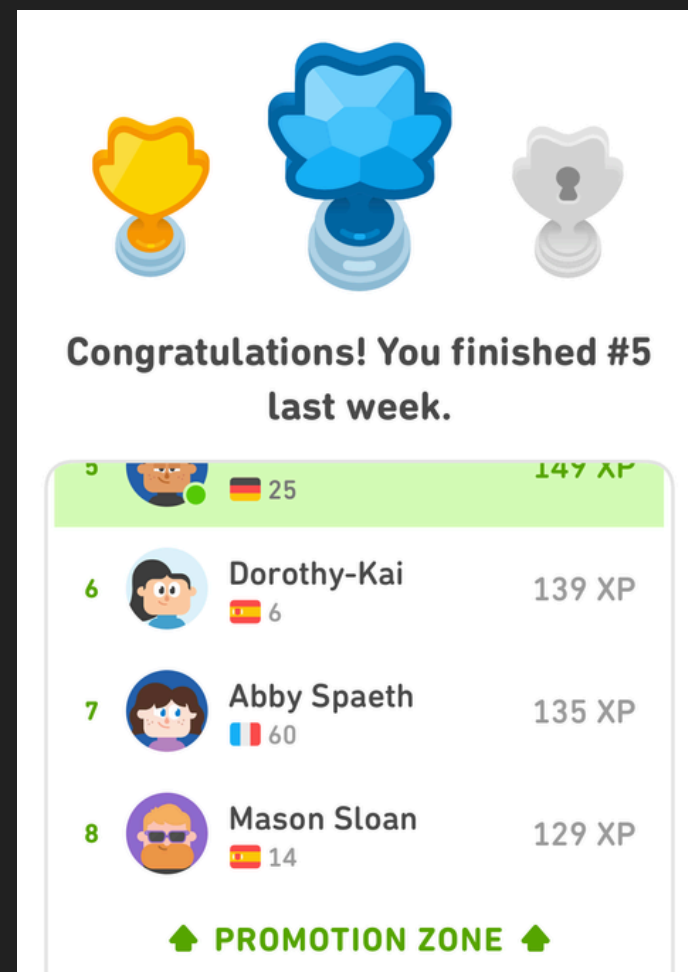
Progress & Mastery



Habit Formation

Duolingo has it all

It's really the only example you need. It's seriously impressive how many game mechanics they crammed into this app.

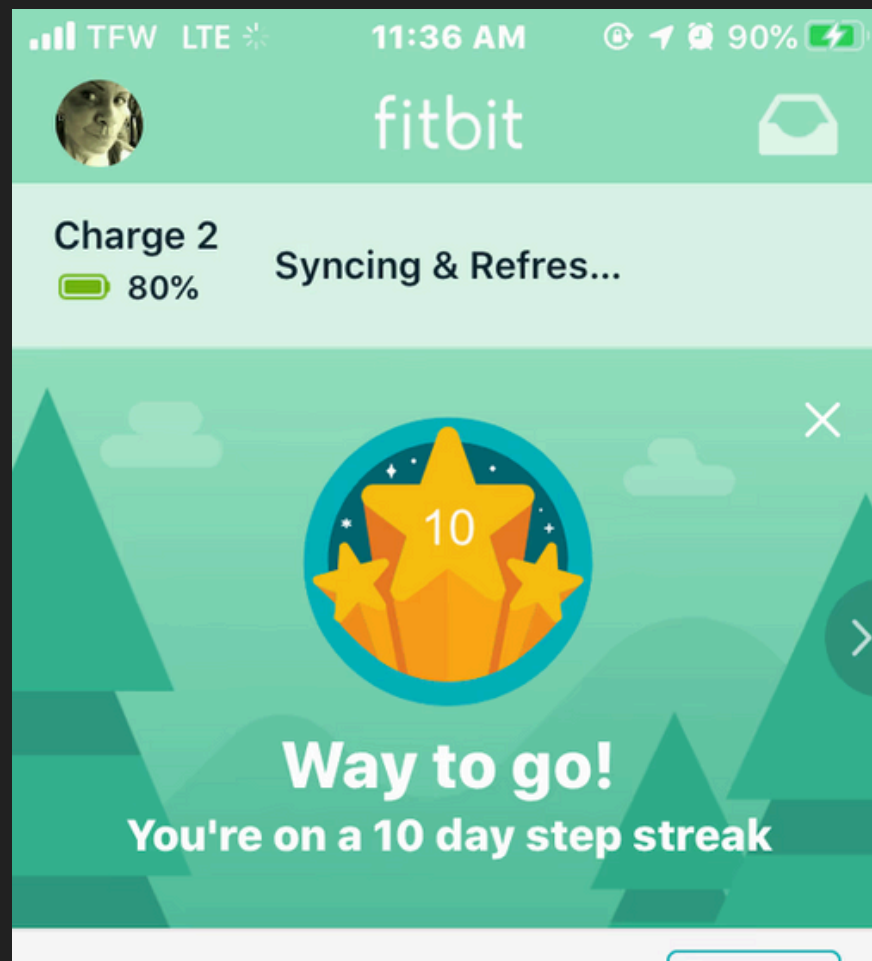


Social Motivation



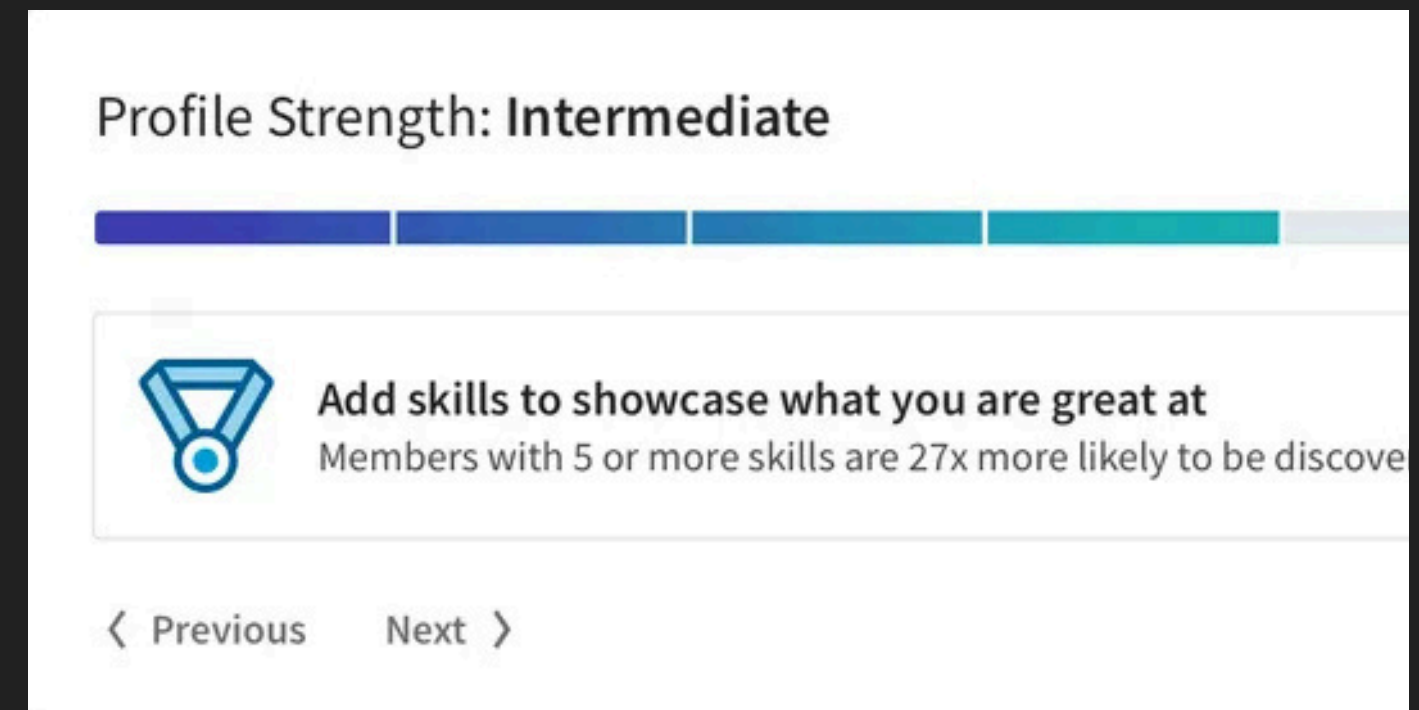
Emotional Engagement

Some other examples



Fitbit

Badges and challenges *motivate* users to build towards healthy habits



LinkedIn

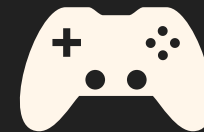
Profile strength meter *motivates* users to complete their profile

Keep an eye on the action verb.



“**motivation**”

Whenever you’re wondering whether to gamify an experience, think: “Is the user lacking intrinsic ***motivation***?”



Now, it's your turn!

Time to build an app.

Workshop Time!

Activity: Redesign a boring/unengaging experience using gamification.

- Break into small groups (2-3 people per group)
- Pick a *mundane* task (brushing teeth, filing taxes, reading for class, recycling)
- Build an app around this task, incorporating **at least 3** gamification mechanics
- Here are a few examples...
 - **Progression systems** (levels, visual progress)
 - **Social competition/collaborations** (leaderboards, team goals)
 - **Rewards/badges** (milestones)
 - **Streaks/habit tracking**
 - **A central character/narrative** (mascot, guide, avatar)
- Afterwards, each group will present their *gamified concept*
- Did the idea end up cohesive? What are some potential pitfalls that could come from implementing this idea?

Ways to Contact Us!



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UXD Discord Server



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